

KNEE SPRAIN

TIPS & STRETCHES TO HELP YOU FEEL BETTER



Knee sprains occur when the ligaments that support your knee stretch or tear.

These tips and exercises can help reduce pain, restore strength and flexibility, and prevent future injuries.



PROTECT, REST, ICE, COMPRESS, ELEVATE

Protect your knee and avoid activities that increase pain.
Ice for 15–20 minutes, 2–3 times per day for the first 48–72 hours.
Use compression and elevate to reduce swelling.



USE SUPPORT

Use a knee brace or wrap if recommended.
Use crutches if needed and follow your provider's guidance.



GRADUALLY RETURN TO ACTIVITY

Increase activity slowly and as pain allows.
Stop if your pain increases or swelling returns.



FOCUS ON STRENGTH

Strengthening the muscles around your knee helps restore stability and prevent future sprains.



WEAR PROPER FOOTWEAR

Wear supportive shoes that fit well.
Avoid uneven surfaces during recovery.



MAINTAIN A HEALTHY WEIGHT

Extra weight increases stress on your knees.
A healthy weight can reduce pain and improve function.



BE PATIENT & CONSISTENT

Healing takes time. Consistent exercises and self-care are key to a full recovery.

WHEN TO SEEK CARE

Seek medical attention if you experience:

- Severe pain or swelling
- Inability to bear weight
- Instability or the knee giving out
- Locking, catching, or clicking
- Numbness, tingling, or discoloration
- Pain that worsens or does not improve within a few days



It's normal for swelling and bruising to last 1–2 weeks or longer.
Keep working on your exercises!

GENTLE EXERCISES FOR KNEE SPRAIN

1 STANDING QUAD STRETCH



- Stand tall and hold onto a chair or wall for balance.
- Bend one knee and bring your heel toward your buttocks.
- Keep your knees close together.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat 2–3 times each leg.

2 SUPINE HAMSTRING STRETCH



- Lie on your back with one knee bent and the other leg straight.
- Loop a strap or towel around the ball of your foot.
- Gently pull your leg toward you until you feel a stretch.
- Keep your knee straight.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat 2–3 times each leg.

3 HAMSTRING CURLS



- Stand behind a chair and hold on for balance.
- Slowly bend one knee, bringing your heel toward your buttocks.
- Squeeze your hamstring.
- Lower slowly.
- Do 10–15 reps.
- Repeat 2–3 sets each leg.

4 CALF RAISES



- Stand with feet hip-width apart and hold onto a chair.
- Slowly rise up onto your toes.
- Hold for 1–2 seconds.
- Slowly lower.
- Do 10–15 reps.
- Repeat 2–3 sets.



Mild discomfort is normal, but exercises should not cause sharp pain.
Stop if pain or swelling increases and consult a healthcare provider.

IF YOUR SYMPTOMS PERSIST OR WORSEN, PLEASE FOLLOW UP WITH YOUR PROVIDER.

This handout is for educational purposes only and is not a substitute for professional medical advice.
Always consult your healthcare provider with any questions or concerns.